



TavaOne Education

General License Course · 2023–2027 Pool

Module 1

Rules & License Upgrade

General License Course · G1 · 5 Exam Questions



Hour 1

Your Upgrade, Your New Privileges



What Upgrading to General Unlocks

Technician → you had VHF/UHF + tiny HF slices (10m phone, small CW slivers)

General → major portions of EVERY HF band

80m: ragchews, traffic nets, NVIS regional comms

40m: the workhorse band — reliable day and night, domestic and DX

20m: the "gentleman's band" — DX most of the day, most of the solar cycle

17m, 15m, 12m, 10m: killer bands near solar maximum

6m: sporadic-E, linked repeaters, EME if you're ambitious

HF portable: POTA, SOTA, ARRL Field Day on real bands



G1A — HF Band Privileges: The Big Picture

General gets large portions of each HF band — Extra gets small additional sub-bands at the low end

The Extra-exclusive segments are narrower than most people expect (25–50 kHz at the phone band bottom)

160m (1.8–2.0 MHz): General has full access — not tested heavily but know it exists

80m (3.5–4.0 MHz): General phone = 3.800–4.000 MHz; Extra extends down to 3.525 for CW

40m (7.0–7.3 MHz): General phone = 7.175–7.300 MHz; Extra CW down to 7.025

30m (10.1–10.15 MHz): CW and digital only — NO phone. 200W PEP max.

20m (14.0–14.35 MHz): General phone = 14.225–14.350 MHz

17m/15m/12m/10m: General gets substantial phone sub-bands on each



G1A — 60-Meter Band Rules

60m is a secondary allocation — amateur is secondary to government users

Operation is CHANNELIZED — 5 specific channels only, you cannot pick a random 60m frequency

Channel center frequencies: 5330.5, 5346.5, 5357.0, 5371.5, 5403.5 kHz

You MUST set your dial to the channel center frequency

MODE: Upper sideband (USB) only for phone — this is the ONE HF band where USB is mandatory regardless of frequency (normally LSB below 10 MHz)

POWER: 100W PEP ERP maximum (not the 1500W general limit)

CW and digital modes are also permitted on 60m — also channelized

Why channelized? Sharing the band with federal agencies requires fixed coordination



G1B — PRB-1 and Antenna Rules

PRB-1 is a federal preemption rule (47 CFR 97.15)

State and local governments **MUST** reasonably accommodate amateur radio antennas

HOAs and municipalities cannot simply ban antennas outright

"Reasonable accommodation" = consideration of aesthetic concerns is allowed, but must not effectively prohibit amateur operation

This has been interpreted broadly by courts — General operators can cite PRB-1 when fighting HOA restrictions

Practically: your city can say "paint it to match the house" — they cannot say "no antennas, period"

FCC does **NOT** pre-approve antenna designs — that's a homeowner association issue

Amateur antenna structures over 200 ft require FAA notification (Part 17)



G1B — Identification Rules

When You MUST ID

- Every 10 minutes during a contact
- At the end of a contact
- When using a club call as control op
- When using a phone patch or autopatch
- When operating a repeater as trustee

When You Do NOT Need to ID

- Within a contact (you can talk without IDing every transmission)
- Brief test transmissions (if no contact is made)
- Tactical call signs in emergencies (but must still ID every 10 min + end of contact)



Hour 2

Control, VE Program, and Remote Rules



G1C — International Operations: CEPT and IARP

CEPT Permit: allows General and Extra class to operate in member countries without a separate license

CEPT members include most of Europe plus some others — ~45 countries total

Technician class does NOT qualify for CEPT — General is the minimum

IARP (International Amateur Radio Permit): for operation in CITEL member countries (Western Hemisphere)

General and above may use IARP; Technician cannot

Third-party traffic: US has formal agreements with about 60+ countries

If no agreement exists: you can still say hi to a foreign ham, but formal third-party messages are prohibited

FCC Form 605: used for license upgrades, renewals, address changes, vanity callsigns — not for CEPT



G1D — The VE Program

VEC (Volunteer Examiner Coordinator): organization that coordinates exam sessions (ARRL, W5YI, etc.)

VE (Volunteer Examiner): individual who is accredited by a VEC to administer exams

Minimum 3 VEs required per exam session — no exceptions

GENERAL CLASS VE: can only administer Element 2 (Technician exam)

EXTRA CLASS VE: can administer Elements 2, 3, and 4 (all three written exams)

VE may NOT examine immediate family members (spouse, parent, child, sibling)

VEs may receive reimbursement for out-of-pocket expenses only — not a salary

Fraudulent exam administration → VE faces revocation of station license AND suspension of operator license

Failed exam → VE team returns the NCVEC Form 605 paperwork to the applicant



G1E — Remote and Automatically Controlled Stations

Remote control: operator is physically separated from the transmitter

The control operator is still responsible for the station — same rules as local operation

Automatic control: no operator present; station operates autonomously

Automatically controlled digital stations CAN relay third-party traffic

Automatically controlled stations CANNOT relay phone or image communications (unless specifically authorized)

If the control link fails: automatically controlled station must cease transmitting within 3 minutes

General is the minimum class for remote control over HF (practical, not explicit — control op privileges determine the band)

Auxiliary stations: fixed digital stations that relay communications between amateur stations



Checkpoint Quiz

What is the maximum power limit for amateur stations operating on the 60-meter band?

A. 100 watts PEP output

B. 1500 watts PEP output

C. 200 watts PEP output



Checkpoint Quiz

Which of the following privileges are available to General class control operators but NOT Technician class?

A. HF phone privileges on 40 and 20 meters

B. Full 2-meter band privileges

C. Repeater operation on 70 centimeters



Checkpoint Quiz

Which of these Volunteer Examiner actions is NOT permitted?

A. Administering an Element 3 exam as a General class VE

B. Reimbursement for expenses incurred preparing the exam

C. Administering an exam to an unrelated adult member of the public



Checkpoint Quiz

What rule or regulation protects amateur radio operators from local zoning laws that would prohibit antenna installation?

A. PRB-1

B. CEPT Agreement

C. Part 15 of the FCC Rules



Checkpoint Quiz

What is the minimum number of licensed amateurs required to supervise an amateur exam session?

A. Three Volunteer Examiners

B. Two Volunteer Examiners

C. One Volunteer Examiner and one VEC representative



HamStudy Assignment

Drill these sections before next module:

G1A — HF Frequency Privileges

G1B — Antenna Rules & ID

G1C — International Ops

G1D — VE Program

G1E — Remote/Auto Control

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